TEACHER GUIDE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Management and leadership

3.2 Managers, leadership and decision making
3.2.1 Understanding management, leadership and decision making



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise management and leadership on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	**45 min**	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same.

1 Manage or lead?

Round 1

Your manager plans the staff rota, sets the budgets and checks the results each week.

Is this mainly management or leadership?

- **A** Leadership: setting a vision
- **B** Leadership: inspiring staff
- **C** Neither: it is just admin
- **D** Management: planning and control

ANSWER

✓ Management: planning and control

Why: Planning, organising and controlling are management; leaders set direction.

2 Autocratic effects

Round 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

- **A** Decisions take longer
- **B** Fast decisions in a crisis
- **C** Staff feel more involved
- **D** Staff gain more responsibility
- **E** Skilled staff feel undervalued

ANSWER

✓ Fast decisions in a crisis
✓ Skilled staff feel undervalued

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

3 Continuum in order

Round 2

Four points on the Tannenbaum-Schmidt continuum.

Order them, boss-centred first?

- **A** Sells: decides, then persuades
- **B** Consults: asks, then decides
- **C** Delegates: the team decides
- **D** Tells: decides and announces

ANSWER

1. **Tells: decides and announces**
2. **Sells: decides, then persuades**
3. **Consults: asks, then decides**
4. **Delegates: the team decides**

Why: Along the continuum the manager uses less authority and staff gain freedom.

Topic tasks

4 Error rate rise

Round 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

ANSWER

50%

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

5 New team, deadline

Round 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

A Clear instructions from the manager

B Let the team decide how

ANSWER

✓ Clear instructions from the manager

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

6 Leading the experts

Round 3

Your senior technicians know the job better than you, and they want to plan the new workshop.

Using Tannenbaum-Schmidt, how should you lead them?

A Delegates: the team decides

B Sells: decides, then persuades

C Tells: decides and announces

D Consults: asks, then decides

ANSWER

✓ Delegates: the team decides

Why: Skilled, keen staff can be given the most freedom on the continuum.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on management and leadership. They come from these 8 questions.

1. A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?
   ✔ **Staff stop raising risks or new ideas**

2. A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?
   ✔ **Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions**

3. A workshop foreman decides every job allocation himself and tells technicians exactly how to do each task. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Autocratic**

4. Before changing opening hours, a sales manager asks the team for views and lets them vote. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Democratic**

5. Experienced technicians set their own hours and methods; the manager steps in only when asked. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Laissez-faire**

6. A brake fault is found on cars in the showroom. Why might an autocratic style suit the next hour?
   ✔ **Fast, clear instructions are needed**

7. An owner decides everything herself but explains each decision and looks after staff welfare. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Paternalistic**

8. What is a main drawback of democratic leadership in a busy dealership?
   ✔ **Decisions can take longer**